

“Explain It to a 12 Year-Old: Communicating Complex Technical Subjects to a Non-Technical Audience”

Project Task

Students will work in groups of four. Each group will select a complex technical concept related to their field and produce a 5–7 minute video explaining the concept to a completely non-technical audience.

The objective is *not to make the explanation childish, but to make a technically accurate concept simple, clear, engaging, and understandable* to an intelligent person with no background in the subject.

Students may use analogies, everyday examples, stories, animations, or simple visualisations.

Required Structure of the video*

Part 1 – The Hook (approximately 1 minute)

The video should begin with something that captures the audience's attention—a question, real-life situation, surprising fact, short story, problem, or demonstration.

Part 2 – Explain the Technology Simply (approximately 3–4 minutes)

Students should explain:

- What the technology/concept is
- How it works at a basic level
- Why it is useful
- Appropriate examples or analogies

Part 3 – Why Should an Ordinary Person Care? (approximately 1–2 minutes)

Students should connect the technology to everyday life. They should answer questions such as:

- Where do we encounter this technology?
- How does it affect ordinary people?
- What problem does it solve?
- What are its benefits or limitations?
- Why might it matter in the future?

Important: All four group members must appear on screen and have a meaningful

speaking role in the video. Simply appearing briefly or reading one or two lines will not be considered sufficient participation.

Evaluation components (Total marks: 40)

1. Technical Content & Accuracy: 10 marks

Understanding of the concept, correctness of information, and appropriate examples.

2. Simplification & Clarity: 20 marks

Ability to explain a complex technical concept in simple, understandable language without unnecessary jargon.

3. Individual Presentation & Communication : 10 marks

Clarity, fluency, pronunciation, confidence, voice modulation, and meaningful participation of all four members.

***If any group wants to deviate from the prescribed structure then they need to email me a pitch explaining what they would like to do instead of this format.**